

- (b) Thrusters A and C are now switched off and the spacecraft is stationary. Thruster B is activated at time t_1 , producing a constant force on the spacecraft until the fuel runs out at time t_2 . As the fuel is used, the total mass of the spacecraft decreases.

On Fig. 2.2, sketch the variation of speed of the spacecraft with time from t_1 to t_2 .

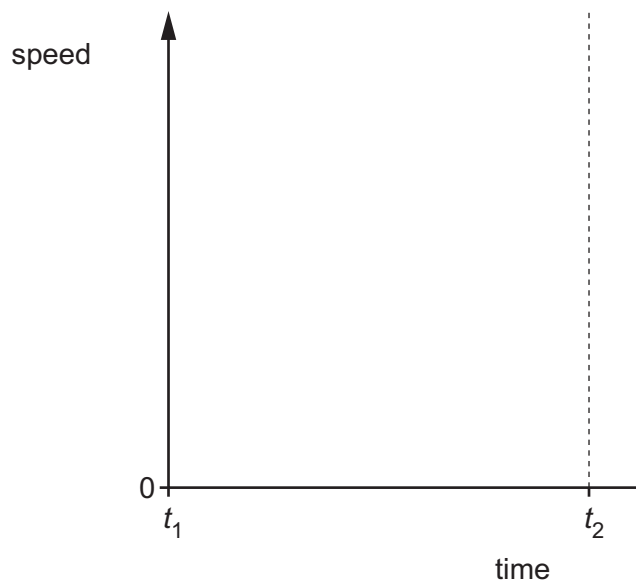


Fig. 2.2

[2]

